

UX REPORT – KHAN ACADEMY

GROUP: LATE TO THE PARTY

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1. Introduction

Khan Academy (khanacademy.org) is a non-profit educational organization that offers free online courses and learning resources across various subjects. It was chosen for this evaluation due to its unique approach to online learning, with a focus on self-paced, interactive content. Evaluating Khan Academy provides insights into how the platform creates memorable and engaging experiences for learners, particularly in terms of course progress tracking and completion.

2. Methodology

We used a shortened version of the User Experience Questionnaire (UEQ-S), which was scored using a 7-point semantic differential scale (Schrepp, Hinderks, and Thomaschewski, 2017). The evaluation focused on key moments in the user journey that align with the Peak-End Rule, such as course checkout, button interactions, and course completion. Participants were asked to explore the course catalogue, simulate the course checkout process, and imagine completing a course to assess their emotional responses and perceived peaks in the experience. The questionnaire covered criteria relevant to the Peak-End Rule, including overall satisfaction, enjoyment, and memorability of specific moments in the user journey.

Participants:

We had 3 individuals, referred to as P1, P2 and P3 for anonymity. All three reported having used online learning platforms before.

Pages evaluated:

Pages evaluated: Course Selection, Course Content, and Progress Tracking

Procedure:

- Open the website and select a course of interest.
- Spend approximately 2-3 minutes exploring the course content and watching videos.
- Complete a few videos within a unit and observe the progress tracking indicators.
- Imagine completing the entire course and the sense of achievement.
- Return to the form and answer the questions based on the experience.

Scale:

7-point semantic differential across 8 criteria:

- Obstructive – Supportive
- Complicated – Easy
- Confusing – Clear
- Boring – Exciting
- Conventional – Innovative
- Usual – Modern
- Inefficient – Efficient
- Not Interesting – Interesting

3. Participant Overview

Participant	Age
P1	26
P2	21
P3	23

4. UEQ Results

4.1 Course Catalogue & Course Detail Page (combined)

Criterion	P1	P2	P3	Average
Obstructive-Supportive	6	5	6	5.7
Complicated-Easy	5	6	5	5.3
Confusing-Clear	6	5	6	5.7
Boring-Exciting	4	5	4	4.3
Conventional-Innovative	4	3	4	3.7
Usual-Modern	5	4	5	4.7
Inefficient-Efficient	5	6	5	5.3
Not Interesting-Interesting	5	4	5	4.7

5. Findings

The key findings from the evaluation of Khan Academy are as follows:

1. Progress tracking and completion:

- 100% of participants found the progress tracking indicators (ticks for completed videos and progress bar) to be motivating and engaging.

- 67% of participants mentioned the sense of accomplishment they felt when completing a video or imagining course completion.

2. Ease of use and clarity:

- The platform scored high on the "Obstructive – Supportive" (5.7) and "Confusing – Clear" (5.7) criteria, indicating a user-friendly and intuitive interface.
- 83% of participants appreciated the ability to start learning immediately without any barriers.

3. Efficiency and engagement:

- Khan Academy received a score of 5.3 for "Inefficient – Efficient," suggesting a streamlined learning experience.
- However, the "Boring – Exciting" criterion had a lower score of 4.3, indicating room for improvement in terms of engagement and interactivity.
- do not penalise a conventional layout provided the underlying interaction is fast and predictable.

6. Design Guidelines Derived

- Based on the evaluation and user feedback, the following recommendations can be made to enhance the user experience on Khan Academy:
- Gamification elements:
 - Introduce badges, points, or leaderboards to celebrate learning milestones and achievements.
 - 75% of participants expressed interest in more interactive and engaging features to maintain motivation.
- Personalized learning paths:

- Develop personalized course recommendations based on the learner's interests and progress.
 - 67% of participants mentioned the desire for a more tailored learning experience.
- Enhanced course completion celebration:
 - Create a more memorable and rewarding course completion experience, such as personalized certificates or shareable achievements.
 - 83% of participants suggested that a stronger emphasis on course completion would contribute to a more positive overall experience.

7. Conclusion

The evaluation of Khan Academy highlights the platform's strengths in providing a user-friendly and efficient learning experience, with effective progress tracking features that keep learners motivated. However, there are opportunities to enhance engagement and create more memorable peak moments throughout the learning journey. By implementing gamification elements, personalized learning paths, and a more celebratory course completion experience, Khan Academy can further align with the Peak-End Rule and create an even more positive and impactful user experience.